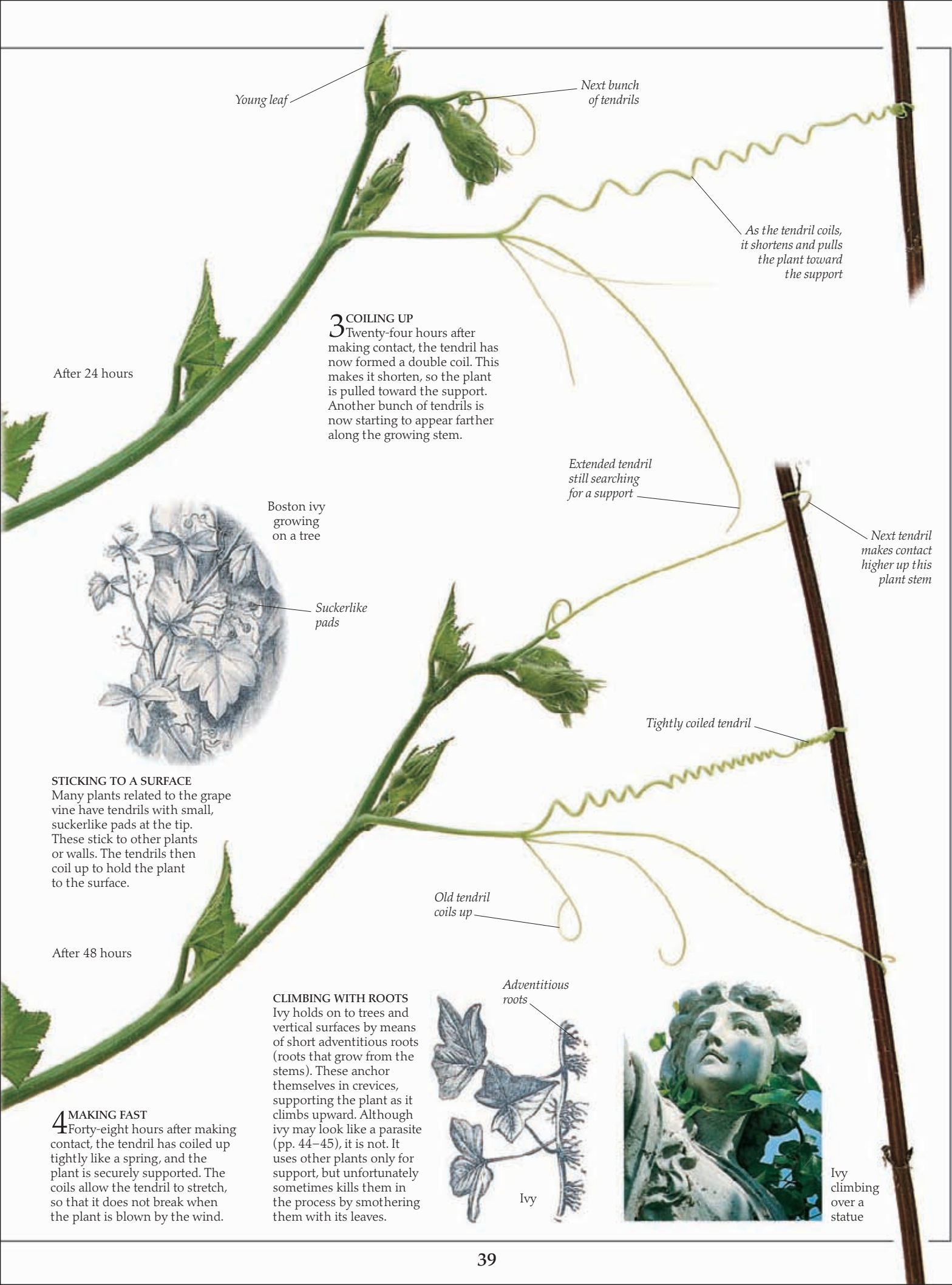




Young leaf

Next bunch of tendrils

As the tendril coils, it shortens and pulls the plant toward the support

After 24 hours

3 COILING UP
Twenty-four hours after making contact, the tendril has now formed a double coil. This makes it shorten, so the plant is pulled toward the support. Another bunch of tendrils is now starting to appear farther along the growing stem.

Extended tendril still searching for a support

Next tendril makes contact higher up this plant stem

Tightly coiled tendril

Old tendril coils up

Adventitious roots

Ivy

Ivy climbing over a statue

Boston ivy growing on a tree

Suckerlike pads

STICKING TO A SURFACE
Many plants related to the grape vine have tendrils with small, suckerlike pads at the tip. These stick to other plants or walls. The tendrils then coil up to hold the plant to the surface.

After 48 hours

4 MAKING FAST
Forty-eight hours after making contact, the tendril has coiled up tightly like a spring, and the plant is securely supported. The coils allow the tendril to stretch, so that it does not break when the plant is blown by the wind.

CLIMBING WITH ROOTS
Ivy holds on to trees and vertical surfaces by means of short adventitious roots (roots that grow from the stems). These anchor themselves in crevices, supporting the plant as it climbs upward. Although ivy may look like a parasite (pp. 44–45), it is not. It uses other plants only for support, but unfortunately sometimes kills them in the process by smothering them with its leaves.

